

Selçuk Cihan

Senior Software Engineer | Backend, Platform & Cloud

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with 17+ years of experience building distributed systems. Former Amazon Software Development Engineer with hands-on experience across Node.js, Python, AWS, GCP, serverless architectures and observability.

Trusted in multi-year remote contracts to own ambiguous problems from architecture and implementation to operations and mentoring. Based in Istanbul (UTC+3).

EXPERIENCE

RTIC Outdoors

2023 - 2026

Senior Software Engineer

- Created mobile device management tools to support warehouse ops, reducing manual device setup and improving reliability across Android-based workflows.
- Automated warehouse operations such as processing returns, customization of products and workflows, resulting in more efficient use of resources.
- Expanded backend observability, giving engineering & operations teams more visibility into failures affecting warehouse.

Serverless Inc.

2022 - 2023

Senior Software Engineer

- Created the Python AWS Lambda SDK for Serverless Console, an observability platform for applications running on AWS Lambda.
- Owned release coordination & backward compatibility of the SDK, supporting dependable adoption among customers.

Tellimer

2019 - 2022

Senior Software Engineer

- Created serverless backends on AWS using Node.js & Python for multiple products, including a machine-learning SAAS application and a substack-like platform for financial writers.
- Designed customer-facing GraphQL APIs, serverless execution orchestration, data-ingestion workflows and priority-queue services for mission-critical financial products.
- Delivered analytics, article recommendation, summarization, and automated sitemap capabilities for customer-facing products on tellimer.com
- Led architecture/design sessions, clarified ambiguous requirements, mentored engineers and reviewed technical documentation.
- Improved production monitoring & operational excellence across distributed systems.

Toptal

2018 - 2019

Senior Software Engineer

- Developed a public facing REST API, fully serverless on AWS, serving hundreds of thousands of customers.
- Reduced AWS bill by more than 50% through architecture and resource-usage optimizations.
- Mentored developers and reviewed design documents for reliability & maintainability.

Amazon

2017 - 2018

Software Development Engineer

- Developed and maintained the orchestration platform that powers Amazon's product catalog.
- Executed zero-downtime migrations across several web services and retired legacy services that constrained catalog growth.

Intertech

2013 - 2017

Senior Software Engineer

- Supported the workflow engine serving banking applications such as loans, customer complaints etc.
- Designed a workforce management system that empowers the bank's operation center.

Ziraat Teknoloji

2011 - 2013

Software Development Engineer

- Implemented workflow engine running on top of Oracle, serving over 100,000 workflow instances daily.
- Served as scrum master and mentored junior developers.

AirTies

2009 - 2010

Software Development Engineer

- Developed solutions for IPTV products in C & C++.
- Implemented teletext and RTSP parsers along with closed captioning and subtitles for IPTV.

EDUCATION

Boğaziçi University

BS. & MS. in Computer Science

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional

Amazon Web Services

SKILLS

TypeScript, Node.js, Python, Java/Scala, SQL/NoSQL, REST/GraphQL, AWS, GCP, Cloudflare, Serverless, Distributed Systems, React

REFERENCES

Daniel Vliegenthart

Team Lead, Tellimer | daniel.vliegenthart@gmail.com

I've been most impressed by his exceptional ability to tackle every phase of software development with in-depth knowledge, confidence and clear communication. I cannot emphasize enough how good Selcuk is at communicating in a clear and structured manner.

Ian Watt

Co-founder, Tellimer | ian.watt@tellimer.com

He was the perfect remote contractor in many ways. His communication skills are top, he is very much a self-starter who can get stuck in on work with minimal guidance or oversight, and his code quality (and documentation!) is exceptional.

Erdem Kurul

Software Development Manager, Intertech | erdemkurul@gmail.com

Selçuk is a quick learner, he approaches problems systematically and understands the business and customer needs. He is very detail-oriented, and a hard worker. You can trust him with the most challenging issues.

Decebal Dobrica

Software Architect, Tellimer | github.com/decebal

I had the pleasure to manage and to work with Selcuk Cihan for the past 2 years while at Tellimer. He rose brilliantly to all challenges thrown at him both technically and communication wise. I would say his superpower is his communications skills, both writing and talking.